Strategy

Project Summary

Scorely is a social music rating web application that allows users to search for songs, rate them on a 1–5 star scale, optionally write short reviews, and track their listening history. The system is not a streaming platform and does not connect to external services like Spotify. Instead, it focuses entirely on user-driven interaction and reflection.

After the third interview, the system emphasizes a simple, clean, and intuitive experience, inspired by Letterboxd. The core interaction flow is:

Search → Rate → Save → Discover through friends

Users can also:

- Bookmark songs for later
- View their rating history
- Follow friends and view their activity
- Showcase their Top 5 songs (manually selected)

The system avoids complexity by removing features such as messaging, notifications, algorithms, and playlists.

User Constituencies

1. Personal Trackers (Jane-type users)
    - Goal: Track and organize personal music taste
    - Use:
        - Rating songs
        - Viewing history
        - Bookmarking songs
    - Behavior: Less social, more reflective
2. Social Explorers (Jake-type users)
    - Goal: Discover music through friends
    - Use:
        - Viewing friend profiles
        - Exploring friend activity
    - Behavior: Social, discovery-driven

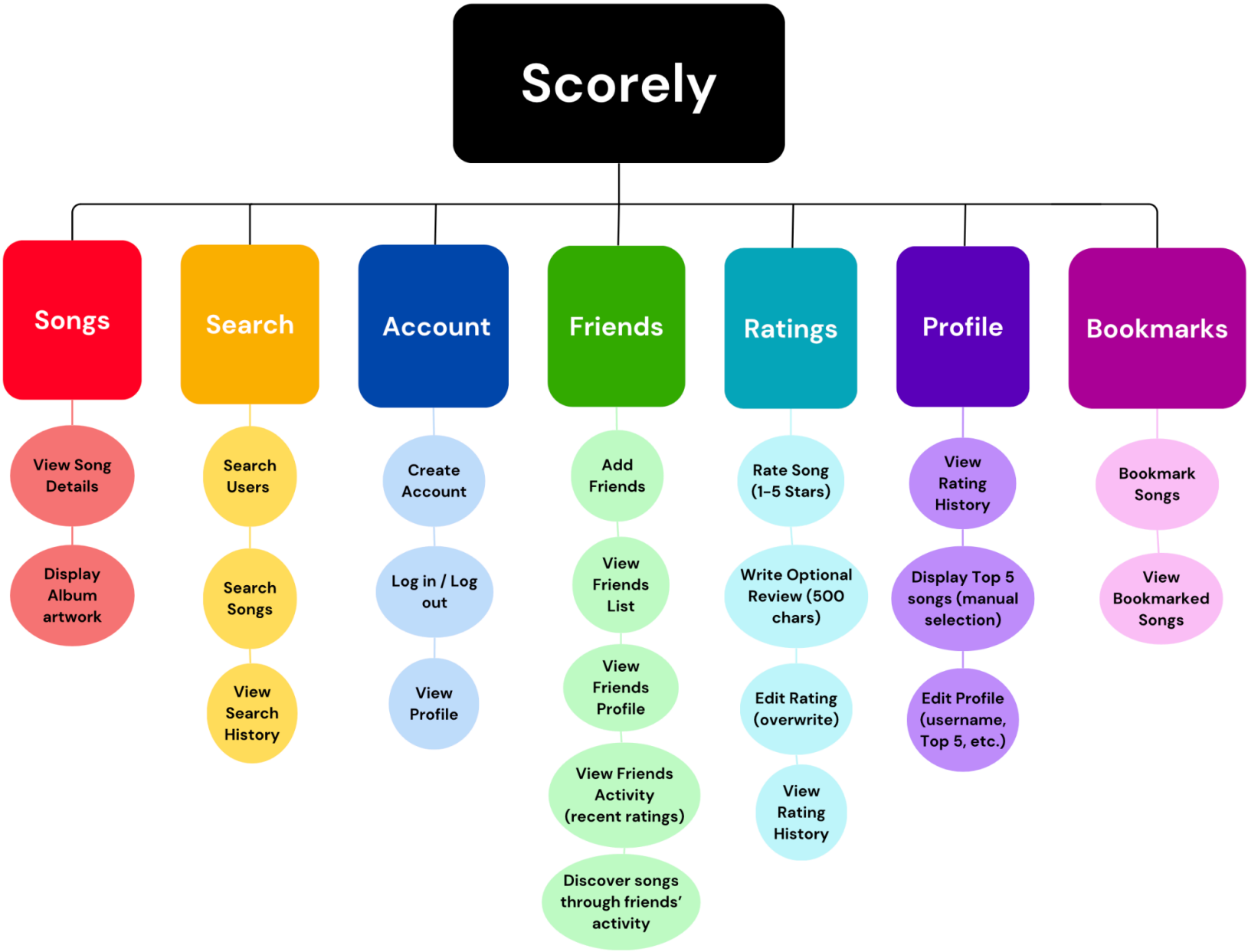
Usage Contexts

- Devices: Mobile-first web app, also usable on desktop
- Environment:
    - At home
    - During free time
    - While listening to music
- Conditions:

    - Requires internet connection
    - Users manually search and log songs
- No automation or background tracking

Scope

Feature Chart

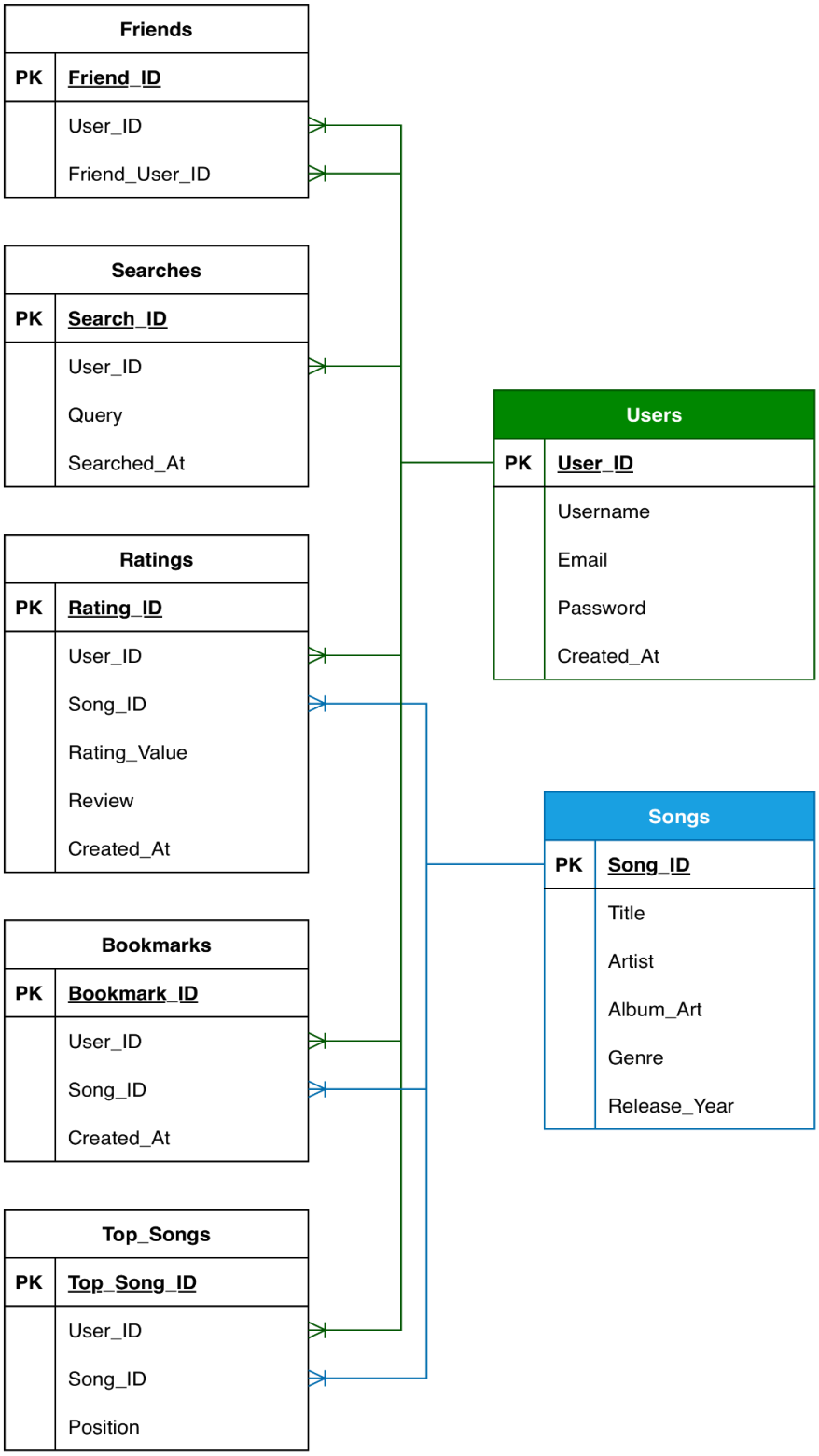


User Stories

1. Account Creation
   As a new user, I want to create an account so that I can save my ratings and activity.
2. Login
   As a user, I want to log into my account so that I can access my personal data.
3. Search Songs
   As a user, I want to search for songs so that I can find music to rate.
4. View Song Details
   As a user, I want to view a song's details so that I can decide how to rate it.
5. Rate Song
   As a user, I want to rate a song from 1–5 stars so that I can record my opinion.
6. Write Review
   As a user, I want to optionally write a short review so that I can express my thoughts.
7. Edit Rating
   As a user, I want to edit my rating so that I can update my opinion over time.
8. View Rating History
   As a user, I want to view my rating history so that I can track what I've rated.
9. Bookmark Songs
   As a user, I want to bookmark songs so that I can revisit them later.
10. View Friend Profile
    As a user, I want to view a friend's profile so that I can see their ratings.
11. View Friend Activity
    As a user, I want to see my friends' recent ratings so that I can discover new music.
12. Set Top 5 Songs
    As a user, I want to select my top 5 songs so that I can showcase my favorites.

Structure

Data Model:



Changes:

After Interview #3, the data model stayed mostly the same, but a few important details were clarified.

The Top 5 songs feature is now confirmed to be manually selected by the user, so the TopSongs entity includes a position (1–5) to store the order.

The rating system was also clarified so that each user can only have one rating per song, and editing a rating replaces the old one instead of creating a new entry.

The friend-based discovery feature remains supported through the relationships between users, ratings, and songs, without requiring additional entities.

Finally, the system continues to focus only on songs, with no separate entities for albums or artists, to keep the design simple

Skeleton

Navigation Plan

Scorely uses a simple tab-based navigation system, inspired by Letterboxd, to ensure ease of use and consistency.

Primary Navigation (Persistent Tabs)

- Home
- Search
- Friends
- Profile

Navigation Behavior

- Users can switch between tabs at any time
- Each tab represents a core section of the app
- Navigation is always visible in a top or bottom bar
- Discovery is handled through the Home and Following Feed sections, where users can see songs their friends have recently rated

Key User Flow

Main Flow:

- User logs in
- Lands on Home page
- Views friend activity (discovery)
- Navigates to Search
- Searches for a song
- Clicks a song to open the Song Detail page

- Rates and optionally reviews the song on the same screen
- Returns to Home, Friends, or Profile

Page Relationships

- Home → Following Feed / Friend Activity → Song Detail
- Search → Song Detail → Rate / Review
- Profile → Top 5 / Rating History / Bookmarks
- Friends → Friend Profile → Friend Top 5 / Recent Ratings
- Following Feed → Friend Ratings → Song Detail

Design Rules

- Minimize the number of pages
- Combine actions into single screens where possible
- Avoid redundant navigation
- Keep interaction simple and direct
- Make friend-based discovery easy to access from the main flow

Authentication Flow

Part 1: Narrative

All users must create an account and log in to access the system.

Account Creation:

Users provide:

- Username
- Email
- Password

The system validates that the email is unique, then creates and stores the account.

Login:

Users enter their email and password. The system verifies the credentials.

If valid:

- The user is authenticated
- The user is redirected to the Home page

After Login:

Once logged in, users land on the Home page where they can:

- View friend activity (discovery)
- Search for songs
- Navigate to their profile and friends

Session Behavior:

- Users remain logged in until they log out
- There are no different user roles; all users have the same level of access

Access Control:

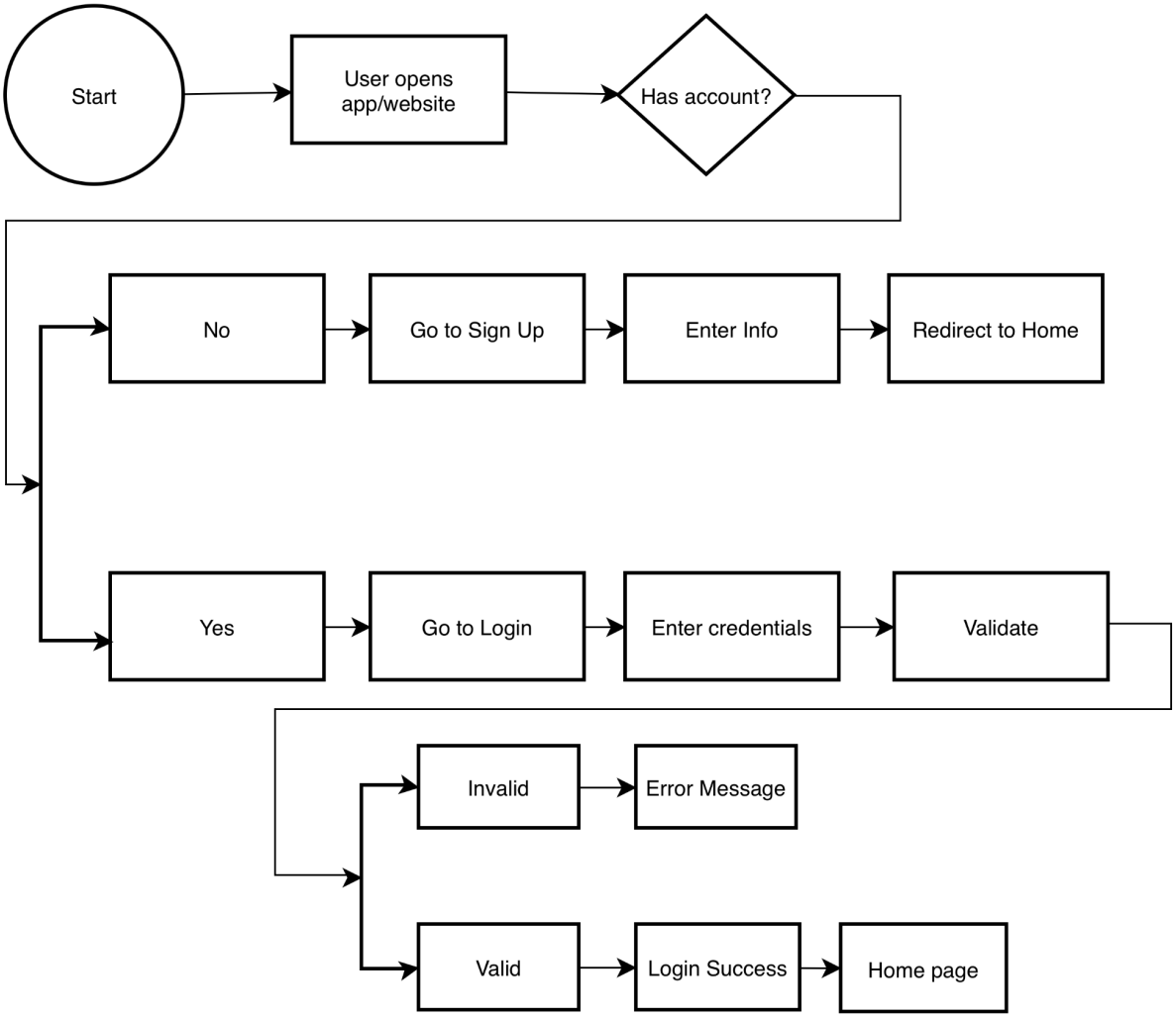
Only logged-in users can:

- Rate songs

- View profiles
- Add friends
- Bookmark songs

There is no guest access to core features.

Part 2: Authentication Flow Chart



Annotated Screenshots from Client Interview

Home page

- KEEP: Homepage as main starting page
- CHANGE: Improve UI so it feels more like a real app/website (reference Letterboxd/Musicboard)
- CHANGE: Make layout more polished and visually appealing
- KEEP: Main links/features are correct

Scorely

Home | Login | Songs | Activity | Friends | Profile

Welcome to Scorely

Scorely is a social music rating app where you can rate songs (1–5 stars), write short reviews, and see what your friends are listening to.

Quick start

1. **Sign in**
   Go to Login.
2. **Find a song**
   Use Songs to search or create a song.
3. **Rate it**
   Open a song detail page (example: Song Detail) and add your rating and review.
4. **See your history**
   Visit My Listening History.
5. **Follow friends**
   Browse Friends and check the Following Feed.

Explore

- My Profile
- Songs
- Activity
- Friends

z

Notes

- Scorely does not stream music; it's a rating journal + social feed.
- One rating per user per song (updates overwrite your previous rating).

Login Page

- KEEP: Current login/account features
- CHANGE: Add more color and better styling
- KEEP: No additional login features requested

Authentication

What this feature is

Authentication lets users create an account, sign in, and sign out so they can store ratings and follow friends.

Links

- Home
- My Profile
- Songs

User stories

- User Story 1: Create an account to store music ratings.
- User Story 9 (rejected): Log in (treated as a system requirement, still needed).

MVP requirements (from PRD)

- Email/password sign up and sign in
- Magic link sign in
- Google sign in
- Sign out
- Profiles row exists for each signed-in user

Primary screens / flows

1. **Sign up**
   Create account with email/password, then redirect into the app.
2. **Sign in**
   Sign in with email/password, magic link, or Google.
3. **Sign out**
   Clear auth session and redirect to Login.

API endpoints used (server)

API endpoints used (server)

- Supabase Auth (client-side): sign up / sign in / OAuth
- Scorely API (server-side):
  - `PATCH /v1/me/profile` (create profile on first login if missing)
  - `GET /v1/me/profile` (read profile)

Edge cases

- Username already taken
- Invalid email/password
- Magic link expired
- Google OAuth canceled

Songs Page

- KEEP: Song search is a core feature
- CHANGE: Search should be the main way users find songs
- CHANGE: Search results should lead directly to song details/rating
- REMOVE: Treating Create Song as a major separate page

Songs

What this feature is

Search for songs in the app database, view details, and create a song if it does not exist.

Links

- Create Song
- Example Song Detail ???

User stories

- User Story 2: Search for songs to find music to rate.

Primary screens

- Song search
- Song detail
- Create song

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/songs` (list / search)
- `POST /v1/songs` (create)
- `GET /v1/songs/:songId` (detail)

Create a Song Page

- REMOVE: Separate songe page
- COMBINE: Song entry should be part of the search/rating flow
- CHANGE: User should search or enter song info while rating, not through a separate page

Create Song

What this feature is

Add a new song (title + artist, optional metadata) when it does not exist in search.

Links

- Back to Songs
- Example Song Detail

Primary fields

- Title (required)
- Artist (required)
- Album (optional)
- Year (optional)

API endpoints used

- `POST /v1/songs`
- `GET /v1/songs` (to confirm it appears in search)

Edge cases

- Duplicate song (same title + artist)
- Validation failures (missing title/artist)

Song Detail Page

- KEEP: Main page for viewing and rating songs
- KEEP: Show song title, artist, album art, and release year
- CHANGE: Place rating near album art
- CHANGE: Place review below rating
- CHANGE: Improve UI styling

Song Detail → Main rating page

Route params

- **songId:** `example-song-id`

What this feature is

The Song Detail page shows a specific song (title + artist) and the current user's rating state for that song. From here the user can create or update a rating and optional review.

User stories

- User Story 2: Search for songs so I can find music to rate.
- User Story 3: Rate songs from 1–5 stars.
- User Story 4: Write reviews about songs.

Rating should be near the album art and the reviews should be at the bottom of the page

Primary UI sections

- **Song metadata**
  Title, artist (album/year optional)
- **My rating**
  Stars 1–5, review text (optional), save/update button
- **Community info (optional)**
  Aggregate rating or recent activity

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/songs/:songId` (load song)
- `GET /v1/me/ratings` (find my existing rating for this song)
- `POST /v1/ratings` (create rating)
- `PATCH /v1/ratings/:ratingId` (update rating)

Edge cases

- Song not found (404)
- Invalid songId format
- User not authenticated
- One rating per user per song (update instead of duplicate)

Ratings & Review Page

- REMOVE: Separate Ratings & Review page
- COMBINE: Move rating and review into Song Detail page
- KEEP: 1–5 stars and optional review

Ratings & Reviews

What this feature is

Ratings are the core of Scorely. Users rate songs from 1–5 stars and can optionally write a short review. Each user can have only one rating per song; editing overwrites the previous rating.

Links

- Find a song
- Example Song Detail
- My Listening History
- Filter: 4–5 Stars

User stories

- User Story 3: Rate a song so I can record my opinion.
- User Story 4: Write a short review so I can express my thoughts.
- User Story 5: Edit my rating so I can update my opinion over time.
- User Story 6: View my rating history so I can see what I've rated.

Rules / constraints

- **Rating scale:** integer 1–5
- **One rating per song:** unique (user_id, song_id)
- **Review:** optional, max 500 characters
- **Edits:** updates overwrite previous rating/review

Primary UI pieces

- **Star selector**
  Choose 1–5 stars
- **Review textbox**
  Optional, up to 500 characters
- **Save / update action**
  Create if missing, update if existing

API endpoints used

- `POST /v1/ratings`
  Create a rating for a song
- `PATCH /v1/ratings/:ratingId`
  Update an existing rating (owned by the current user)
- `GET /v1/me/ratings`
  My rating history (supports minRating filter)
- `GET /v1/ratings?userId=:userId&songId=:songId`
  Lookup ratings (admin-style list/search)

Error cases

- 422 validation failed (bad song_id UUID, rating not 1–5)
- 403 operation not allowed (editing someone else's rating)
- 409 conflict (duplicate rating row if uniqueness is violated)

Find a Song Page

- REMOVE/COMBINE: Merge this into the main Songs/Search page
- CHANGE: Keep one simple search flow

Goes directly to the Songs Page to create a song. Is that what we want

Songs

merge with song page

What this feature is

Search for songs in the app database, view details, and create a song if it does not exist.

Links

- Create Song
- Example Song Detail

User stories

- User Story 2: Search for songs to find music to rate.

Primary screens

- Song search
- Song detail
- Create song

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/songs` (list / search)
- `POST /v1/songs` (create)
- `GET /v1/songs/:songId` (detail)

Bookmarks Page

- KEEP: Bookmark songs to revisit later
- KEEP: Simple general bookmarks list
- CHANGE: No genre sections or extra organization needed

Bookmarks

What this feature is

Bookmarks let you save songs you want to come back to later. A bookmark is tied to your account and references a song.

Links

- Find a song to bookmark
- Example Song Detail
- Rate & Review a Song
- My Profile

User stories

- User Story 7: Bookmark songs so I can come back to them later.

Rules / constraints

- **Uniqueness:** one bookmark per (user, song)
- **Ownership:** you can only delete your own bookmarks

Primary UI pieces

- **Bookmarks list**
  Shows bookmarked songs (often newest first)
- **Add bookmark**
  Triggered from song detail or search results
- **Remove bookmark**
  Deletes a bookmark

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/bookmarks`
  List my bookmarks
- `POST /v1/bookmarks`
  Create a bookmark (body: song_id)
- `GET /v1/bookmarks/:bookmarkId`
  Get bookmark detail by id
- `DELETE /v1/bookmarks/:bookmarkId`
  Delete a bookmark I own

Error cases

- 422 validation failed (song_id missing or not a UUID)
- 403 operation not allowed (trying to delete someone else's bookmark)
- 404 resource not found

Search History Page

- KEEP: Search history feature
- KEEP: Recent searches can stay
- NO MAJOR CHANGES

Search History

What this feature is

Search History keeps a record of the song searches you've made, so you can quickly repeat a search later. Each entry stores the query text and when it was searched.

Links

- Search songs
- My Bookmarks
- Activity
- My Profile

User stories

- User Story 2: Search for songs so I can find music to rate.
- Search feature: View Search History so I can repeat searches easily.

Rules / constraints

- **Query length:** 1–255 characters
- **Ownership:** you can only view / delete your own search history

Primary UI pieces

- **Recent searches list**
  Ordered by newest first
- **Repeat search**
  Click an entry to populate the search input
- **Clear entry / clear all**
  Delete a single search (or all searches)

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/searches`
  List my search history
- `POST /v1/searches`
  Log a search query (body: query)
- `GET /v1/searches/:searchId`
  Get one search entry by id (owner only)
- `DELETE /v1/searches/:searchId`
  Delete one search entry (owner only)

Error cases

- 422 validation failed (query missing or too long)
- 403 operation not allowed (trying to access someone else's search)
- 404 resource not found

Activity Page

- KEEP: Activity page
- CHANGE: Focus on friend activity and personal rating history
- CHANGE: Keep this section simple
- COMBINE WHERE POSSIBLE: Avoid too many separate activity pages

Activity

What this feature is

View rating activity over time. This includes your personal listening history and a feed of rating activity from people you follow.

Links

- Following Feed
- My Listening History
- Filter: 4–5 Stars

User stories

- User Story 6: View my listening history.
- User Story 5: Filter listening history by 4–5 stars.

Primary screens

- My listening history
- Following feed

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/me/ratings` (my history)
- `GET /v1/activity` (following feed)

Following Feed Page

- KEEP: Following feed
- KEEP: Supports friend-based music discovery
- CHANGE: Improve UI styling

Following Feed

What this feature is

Shows rating activity from the users you follow (most recent updates first). Activity is derived from rating create/update events.

Links

- Back to Activity
- My Listening History

User stories

- View a feed of rating activity from users I follow.

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/activity`

My Listening History Page

- KEEP: Listening history
- KEEP: Show ratings from most recent to oldest
- CHANGE: Should connect well with profile and scrollable rating list

My Listening History

What this feature is

Shows all of your ratings ordered by most recently updated.

Links

- Back to Activity
- Filter: 4–5 Stars
- Following Feed

User stories

- User Story 6: View my listening history.

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/me/ratings`

Listening History Filter Page

- OPTIONAL: Filtering can stay if simple
- LOW PRIORITY: Not a main focus for final prototype
- CHANGE: Do not overcomplicate

Listening History Filter (4–5 Stars) Low priority

What this feature is

Shows only ratings where stars are 4 or 5. This does not change stored data.

Links

- Back to History
- Following Feed

User stories

- User Story 5: Filter my listening history by 4–5 star ratings.

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/me/ratings?minRating=4`

Friends Page

- KEEP: Friends page
- KEEP: Browse users, follow users, and view friend profiles
- KEEP: Friends are important for discovery
- CHANGE: Keep social features simple

Friends

No messaging between friends

What this feature is

Follow other users to see their ratings and discover music through social connections.

Links

- Example Friend Profile
- Example Friend Top 5

User stories

- User Story 7: View a friend's profile to see their ratings.
- User Story 8: See a friend's top five songs to discover music.

Primary screens

- Find users / browse users
- Friend profile
- Follow / Unfollow

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/profiles` (search/browse users)
- `GET /v1/profiles/:userId` (view user)
- `POST /v1/friends/:userId` (follow)
- `DELETE /v1/friends/:userId` (unfollow)

Friends Profile Page

- KEEP: Friend profile page
- CHANGE: Should look similar to the user's own profile
- KEEP: Show ratings and Top 5 songs

Friend Profile

same structure as profile

Route params

- **userId:** `example-user-id`

What this feature is

View another user's profile, their recent ratings, and follow/unfollow them to customize your feed.

Links

- Back to Friends
- Top 5 Songs

User stories

- User Story 7: View a friend's profile to see their ratings.
- User Story 8: See a friend's top five songs to discover music.

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/profiles/:userId`
- `GET /v1/ratings?userId=:userId` (recent ratings)
- `POST /v1/friends/:userId` (follow)
- `DELETE /v1/friends/:userId` (unfollow)

Friends Top 5 Songs page

- CORRECT: Top 5 songs should be manually selected
- REMOVE: “Based on highest ratings”
- REMOVE: “Computed from ratings”
- KEEP: Friend Top 5 display

Friend Top 5 Songs

Route params

- **userId:** `example-user-id`

What this feature is

Shows a friend’s top 5 songs ~~based on highest rating~~, breaking ties by most recently updated.

Links

- Back to Friend Profile
- Back to Friends

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/profiles/:userId`
- `GET /v1/ratings?userId=:userId`

Notes

- Top 5 is computed (not stored) from ratings data.

Profile Page

- KEEP: Profile page
- KEEP: Top 5 songs should appear clearly on profile
- CHANGE: Top 5 should be near the top
- CHANGE: Show all rated songs below in a scrollable list

My Profile

Links

- Home
- My Listening History
- Following Feed
- Find Friends
- Browse Songs

Profile information

This page contains the complete set of profile information the app will display.

Identity

- **Username:** (from profiles)
- **Display name:** (optional)
- **Avatar:** (optional)
- **Member since:** (created_at)

Editable fields

- Username (unique)
- Display name (optional)
- Avatar URL (optional)

Stats / summary

- **Total ratings:** (count)
- **Average rating:** (optional)
- **Bookmarks:** (count)
- **Following:** (count)
- **Followers:** (optional)

Recent ratings

Shows your most recent rating updates. Each entry will include song, stars, and an optional review snippet.

- Go to full listening history

Top 5 songs

Computed from your ratings: highest rating first, ties broken by most recently updated.

Bookmarks

Shows songs you bookmarked to revisit later.

Friends / following

Shows who you follow and (optionally) who follows you.

What this feature is

View and update your profile, including your username, and see your own ratings summary.

User stories

- Profile is required to support rating and following features.

Primary screens

- My profile details
- My recent ratings
- Top 5 songs (optional per task list)

API endpoints used

- `GET /v1/me/profile`
- `PATCH /v1/me/profile`
- `GET /v1/me/ratings`
- `GET /v1/bookmarks`
- `GET /v1/friends`

These screenshots reflect the final feedback from the client during Interview #3. Overall, most of the page structure was approved, but a few important changes were requested. The client wants the design to look more polished, with fewer separate pages related to songs. The rating and review features should be combined into the Song Detail page instead of being separate. The Top 5 songs feature was also clarified to be manually selected by the user, rather than automatically generated. In general, the final design should include album artwork, clearly visible ratings, and a clean layout similar to apps like Letterboxd. It should also support discovery through friend activity, allowing users to easily see and explore songs their friends have recently rated.